



BALANCEDESK

Client Guide

Version 1.2.0

Windows desktop guide with a Linux quick reference

PRIVATE

Local user accounts

OFFLINE

No internet required

LOCAL DATA

Stored on this computer

A practical guide for setup, daily operations, reconciliation, closing, and recovery.

Prepared 30 August 2026

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Illustrative data only

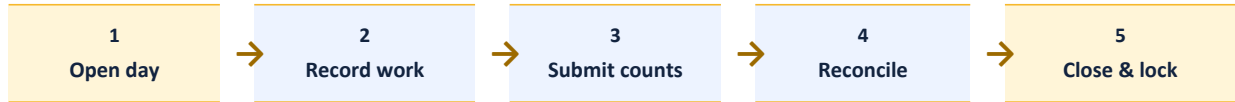


Every name, amount, reference, and account shown in this guide is fictional. Never use training screenshots as a substitute for checking your own workspace.

START HERE

Quick start

BalanceDesk is a private, offline workspace for recording daily business activity and reconciling the day before it is locked.



The shortest safe routine

- Open BalanceDesk and sign in with your local username and password.
- An Administrator opens the Business Day with the opening cash, coins, and MoMo balance.
- Record MoMo Sales, Credit Sales, Credit Payments, and Expenses as they happen.
- At closing time, count all physical cash and obtain the actual closing MoMo balance.
- Submit counts, enter the authoritative Total Sales figure, review the reconciliation, then confirm and close.
- Stop BalanceDesk and create a verified backup regularly—especially before updates, restore, or import.

Cash sales are calculated



BalanceDesk does not contain an individual Cash Sale entry screen. Cash Sales are derived at reconciliation from the physical cash count, opening drawer values, cash credit payments, and cash expenses.

Never delete the data folder to troubleshoot



Installed business data and backups are kept under %LOCALAPPDATA%\BalanceDesk. Preserve that folder and its logs if you need support.

What each role can do

Task	Standard user	Administrator
Record MoMo Sales, Credit Sales, Credit Payments, Expenses	Yes	Yes
Submit end-of-day counts	Yes	Yes
Open a Business Day	No	Yes
Set Total Sales, reconcile, and finally close	No	Yes
Create local users, review customers, audit history	No	Yes
Correct, reverse, return, or reopen controlled records	No	Yes

GUIDE MAP

Find the task you need

Use this guide from beginning to end for training, or jump to the relevant section during daily work.

Section	Use it for
1 · Install and set up	Windows installation, a new workspace, existing-data import, and sign-in
2 · Daily workflow	Opening the day, entry screens, status changes, and safe record handling
3 · Customers and credit	Customer accounts, invoices, payment allocation, and classification review
4 · Counts and reconciliation	Closing counts, Total Sales, calculation review, and discrepancy handling
5 · Close, audit, and correct	Final close, locked snapshots, Activity History, returns, and reopening
6 · Local users	Standard-user accounts, passwords, and account responsibilities
7 · Data safety	Stop, backup, restore, import, diagnostics, updates, and uninstall
8 · Troubleshooting	Start failures, stale screens, duplicate prevention, and support evidence
9 · Linux quick reference	Supported Linux systems, setup, daily use, and updates
Appendices	Calculation formulas, worked example, glossary, and close checklist

Product scope

- i** This guide describes BalanceDesk v1.2.0. A later build may contain small wording or visual refinements, but the safe operating sequence remains the same unless release notes say otherwise.

SECTION 1

Install and set up BalanceDesk

The Windows installer is the recommended client format. It installs for the current Windows account and does not require Administrator rights, Node.js, PowerShell, or an internet connection.

Install on Windows

1. Double-click BalanceDesk-Setup-v1.2.0-windows-x64.exe.
2. Choose Start with a new workspace or Use existing BalanceDesk data. Existing data may be a trusted .db file or an extracted portable BalanceDesk folder.
3. Choose whether to create a desktop shortcut, then select Install BalanceDesk.
4. Select Open BalanceDesk when installation completes.

Unknown-publisher warning

Until release executables are code-signed, Windows may show an unknown-publisher warning. Use only the official BalanceDesk release and verify its supplied SHA-256 checksum before running a transferred installer.

Official public repository: github.com/Ritchalison/BalanceDesk

Installed application: %LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\BalanceDesk

Installed business data: %LOCALAPPDATA%\BalanceDesk

Reinstall or update: Existing detected workspace data is preserved automatically.

1.1 Create the first local workspace

Use this screen only when you are starting a new workspace. Keep the setup code private; it grants the right to create the first Administrator.

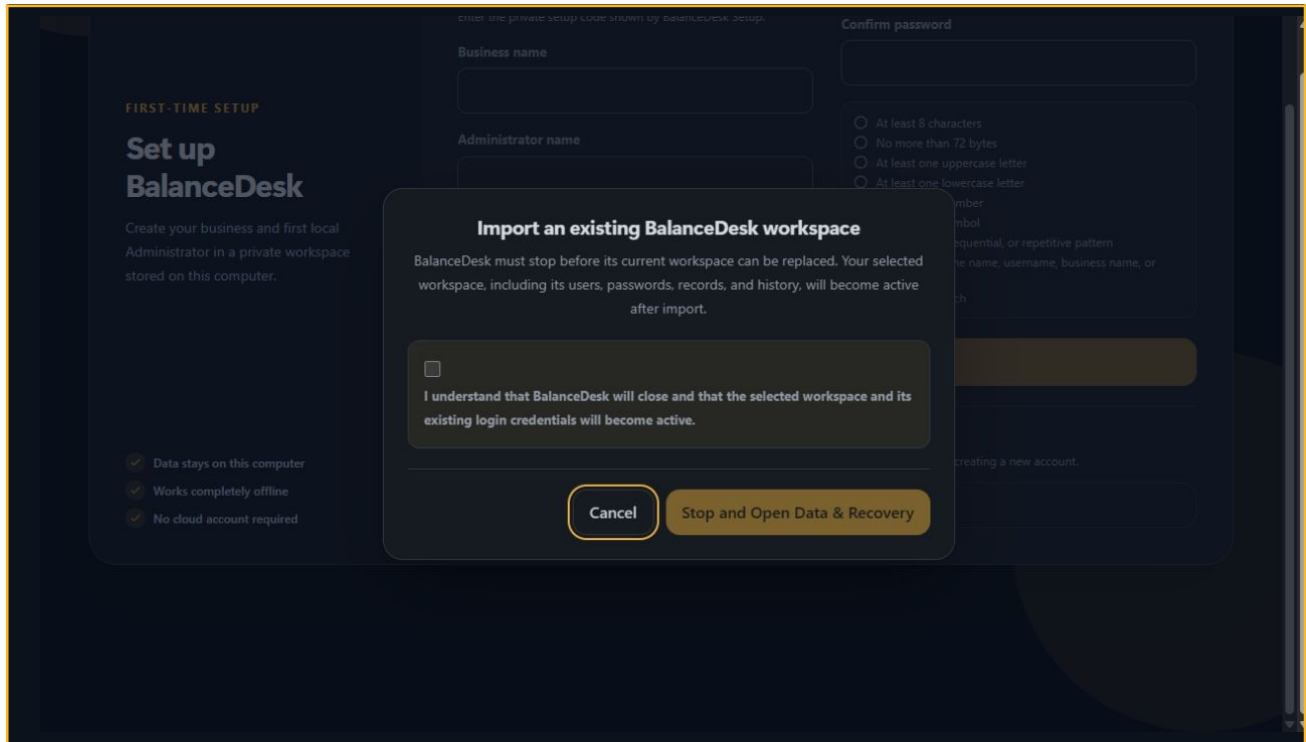
The screenshot shows the 'Set up BalanceDesk' interface. On the left, a sidebar contains the BalanceDesk logo, the text 'FIRST-TIME SETUP', the title 'Set up BalanceDesk', and instructions: 'Create your business and first local Administrator in a private workspace stored on this computer.' Below this are three checked items: 'Data stays on this computer', 'Works completely offline', and 'No cloud account required'. The main area is divided into two columns. The left column, titled 'Workspace details', contains input fields for 'Local setup code' (with a note to enter the code from the setup), 'Business name', 'Administrator name', and 'Administrator username'. The right column, titled 'Password and security', contains a 'Password' field, a 'Confirm password' field, and a list of password requirements: 'At least 8 characters', 'No more than 72 bytes', 'At least one uppercase letter', 'At least one lowercase letter', 'At least one number', 'At least one symbol', 'No common, sequential, or repetitive pattern', 'Does not use the name, username, business name, or BalanceDesk', and 'Passwords match'. At the bottom of the main area are two buttons: 'Create local workspace' and 'Import existing data' (with a note to import an existing database or extracted portable workspace instead of creating a new account).

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1 **Setup code** — Copy the private code shown by BalanceDesk Setup into Local setup code.
- 2 **Workspace identity** — Enter the business name, Administrator name, and a memorable Administrator username.
- 3 **Strong password** — Complete every password check and store the Administrator credentials safely.
- 4 **Create** — Select Create local workspace once every required field and password rule is valid.
- 5 **Existing data** — Use Import existing data instead when you already have a trusted BalanceDesk database or extracted portable folder.

1.2 Import instead of creating a new workspace

The setup-page import action safely closes BalanceDesk and opens Data & Recovery. It is a complete workspace replacement—not an account merge.



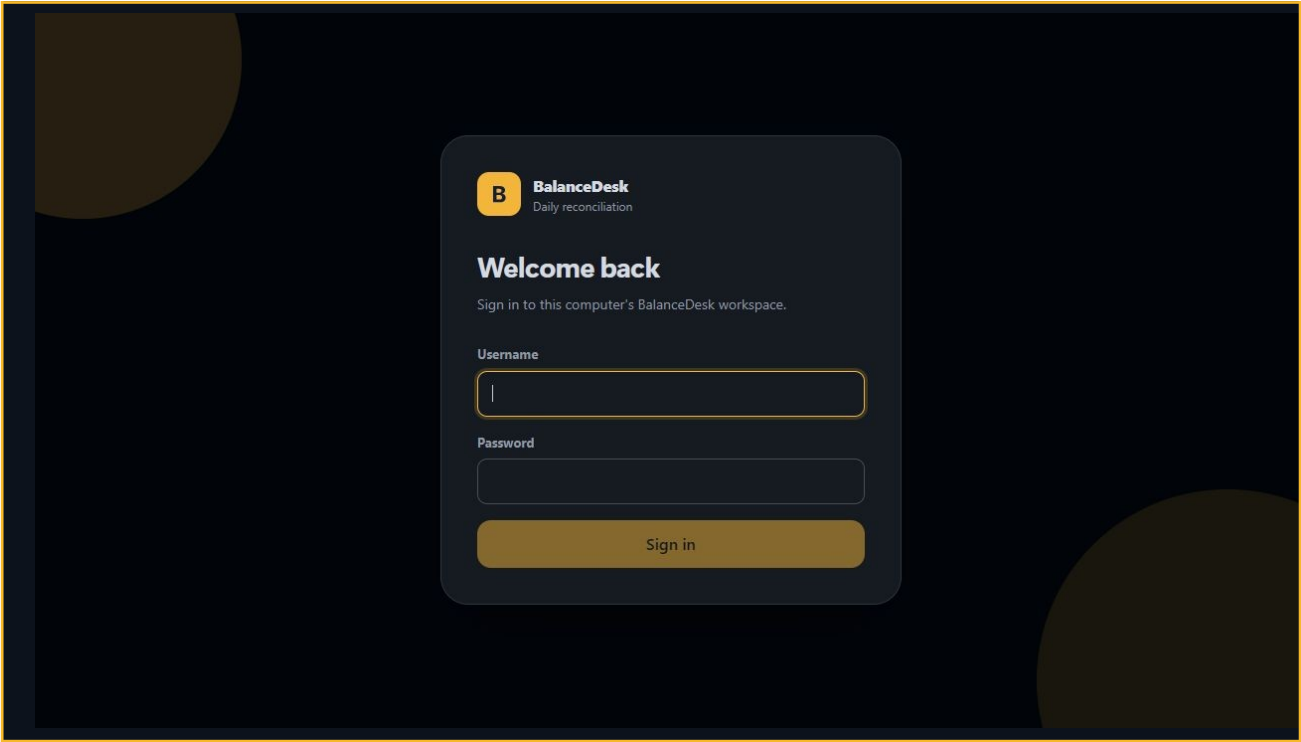
Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1 **Read the warning** — The selected workspace brings its users, passwords, records, and history.
- 2 **Acknowledge** — Tick the confirmation only when you know an Administrator login from the workspace being imported.
- 3 **Continue** — Select Stop and Open Data & Recovery, then choose the trusted .db file or extracted portable folder.

Note: Import signs out old sessions and makes the imported login credentials active.

1.3 Sign in

Every account is local to this computer and workspace. There is no cloud account or online password recovery.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

1	Username — Enter the local username created by the Administrator or imported with the workspace.
2	Password — Enter the matching local password; passwords are case-sensitive.
3	Sign in — Select Sign in. Your navigation and permissions are based on your role.

Note: If credentials are forgotten, contact the local Administrator. Do not delete or replace the database to reset a password.

SECTION 2

Daily workflow

BalanceDesk permits one active Business Day at a time. The status badge at the top-right tells you where the day is in the close sequence.

Status	Meaning	What happens next
Open	Operational records and counts are writable according to role.	Record work; submit counts when finished.
Counts submitted	Physical cash and actual closing MoMo are recorded.	Administrator enters Total Sales and reviews.
Ready to close	Reconciliation has been confirmed.	Administrator performs final close or returns for correction.
Closed	The day is read-only and has an immutable snapshot.	Review it in Closed Days; reopen only for a controlled correction.
Reopened	An authorised correction cycle is active.	Administrator corrects, resubmits, reconfirms, and creates a new snapshot.

Record once



After any submit, wait for the result. If the screen appears stale, refresh and check the records table before entering the transaction again. This prevents accidental duplicates.

2.1 Open the Business Day — Administrator

Opening values are the starting position for the reconciliation. Enter what is physically present before normal daily trading begins.

The screenshot shows the 'Open Business Day' interface in BalanceDesk. The sidebar on the left includes the following sections:

- Workspace:** Overview, Open Business Day (selected).
- Operations:** MoMo Sales, Credit Sales, Credit Payments, Expenses.
- Management:** Customers, Customer Review, Closed Days.
- User Profile:** Synthetic Ad... Administrator.

The main form, titled 'Open Business Day', contains the following fields:

- Business Date:** 30/08/2026
- Drawer Cash (GHS):** 1000.00
- Drawer Coins (GHS):** 50.00
- Opening MoMo Balance (GHS):** 2500.00

At the bottom of the form is a yellow button labeled 'Open Business Day'.

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- Business date** — Confirm the date. Only one day can be active at a time.
- Drawer cash** — Enter notes and other cash in the drawer at opening.
- Drawer coins** — Enter coins separately; BalanceDesk combines both values as the opening drawer float.
- Opening MoMo** — Enter the verified wallet balance before the day's MoMo activity.
- Open** — Select Open Business Day and confirm the new Open status.

2.2 Record a MoMo Sale

Record the amount and provider. Names, phone numbers, transaction references, and receipt references improve traceability even when a field is optional.

B

BalanceDesk

Daily reconciliation

Synthetic Acceptance Worksp...

WORKSPACE

Overview

Current Day

Submit Counts

OPERATIONS

MoMo Sales

Credit Sales

Credit Payments

Expenses

MANAGEMENT

Customers

Customer Review

Closed Days

Activity History

Local Users

Synthetic Ad...

Administrator

MoMo Sales

30 August 2026Open

Today's MoMo Sales

GH¢1,200.00

1 entry

Record MoMo Sale

Amount (GHS)

MoMo provider

Select provider

Transaction date

30/08/2026

Transaction time

01:06

Payer or customer name (optional)

Payer phone number (optional)

MoMo transaction reference (optional)

Invoice or receipt reference (optional)

Note (optional)

Record MoMo Sale

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1

Amount and provider — Enter the sale amount and choose the correct MoMo network.
- 2

Date and time — Confirm when the transaction happened; do not move sales between business dates.
- 3

References — Record the MoMo transaction ID and invoice or receipt reference when available.
- 4

Submit — Select Record MoMo Sale once and wait for the success notice and updated total.
- 5

Records — Use the record list to confirm the entry; newer records appear first.

2.3 Record a Credit Sale

A Credit Sale belongs to a customer account and should carry an invoice or sale reference. You may create a provisional customer when no existing customer matches.

B

BalanceDesk

Daily reconciliation

Synthetic Acceptance Worksp...

WORKSPACE

Overview

Current Day

OPERATIONS

MoMo Sales

Credit Sales

Credit Payments

Expenses

MANAGEMENT

Customers

Customer Review

Closed Days

Activity History

Local Users

Synthetic Ad...

Administrator

Credit Sales

30 August 2026Reopened

Today's Credit Sales

GH¢800.00

1 entry

Record Credit Sale

Select customer

Q

Type a name, customer code, or phone

Search and select an existing customer. If there is no match, create a provisional customer here.

Invoice or sale reference

Transaction date

30/08/2026

Transaction time

01:17

Due date

dd/mm/yyyy

Credit sale amount (GHS)

Item or sale description (optional)

Note (optional)

Record Credit Sale

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1

Customer — Search and select the correct customer. Create a provisional customer only after checking for duplicates.
- 2

Invoice reference — Use the business’s invoice or sale reference so the account can be audited.
- 3

Date and due date — Confirm the transaction date and the agreed payment due date.
- 4

Amount and details — Enter the full credit amount and a useful item or sale description.
- 5

Submit — Select Record Credit Sale once; confirm it appears in the records list and customer ledger.

Note: The Reopened badge in this training image indicates a controlled correction cycle. A normal trading day shows Open.

2.4 Record a Credit Payment

Find the customer first. You can then record Cash or MoMo and allocate the payment to one or more open invoices when appropriate.

Credit Payments

30 August 2026 Reopened

Cash Credit Payments
GH¢400.00
1 entry

MoMo Credit Payments
GH¢300.00
1 entry

Record Credit Payment

Find an existing customer
Search by name, customer code, or phone.
Results are limited to one page at a time.

Search customers

Name, code, or phone

Demo Credit Customer
C-1F73E839E5

Find and select an active Credit Customer before recording a payment.

Credit Payment records
2 Credit Payment records. Showing 1–2. Newest records appear first.

DATE AND TIME	CUSTOMER	CHANNEL
30 Aug 2026, 1:08 am	Demo Credit Customer	MoMo MTN Mobile Money
30 Aug 2026, 1:07 am	Demo Credit Customer	Cash

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1 Find customer** — Search by name, customer code, or phone, then select the matching active account.
- 2 Amount and channel** — Enter the amount and select Cash or MoMo; the channel affects reconciliation.
- 3 Allocation** — Allocate against open invoices when known. Unallocated credit remains visible on the customer account.
- 4 Reference** — Capture a receipt or transaction reference so payment evidence can be traced.
- 5 Verify** — Confirm the new payment in the record table and on the customer account.

Note: A Cash Credit Payment is not today's sale; BalanceDesk removes it when calculating Cash Sales. A MoMo Credit Payment is included in expected closing MoMo.

2.5 Record an Expense

Choose a consistent category, describe the expense clearly, and use the actual payment channel. Cash and MoMo expenses affect different reconciliation figures.

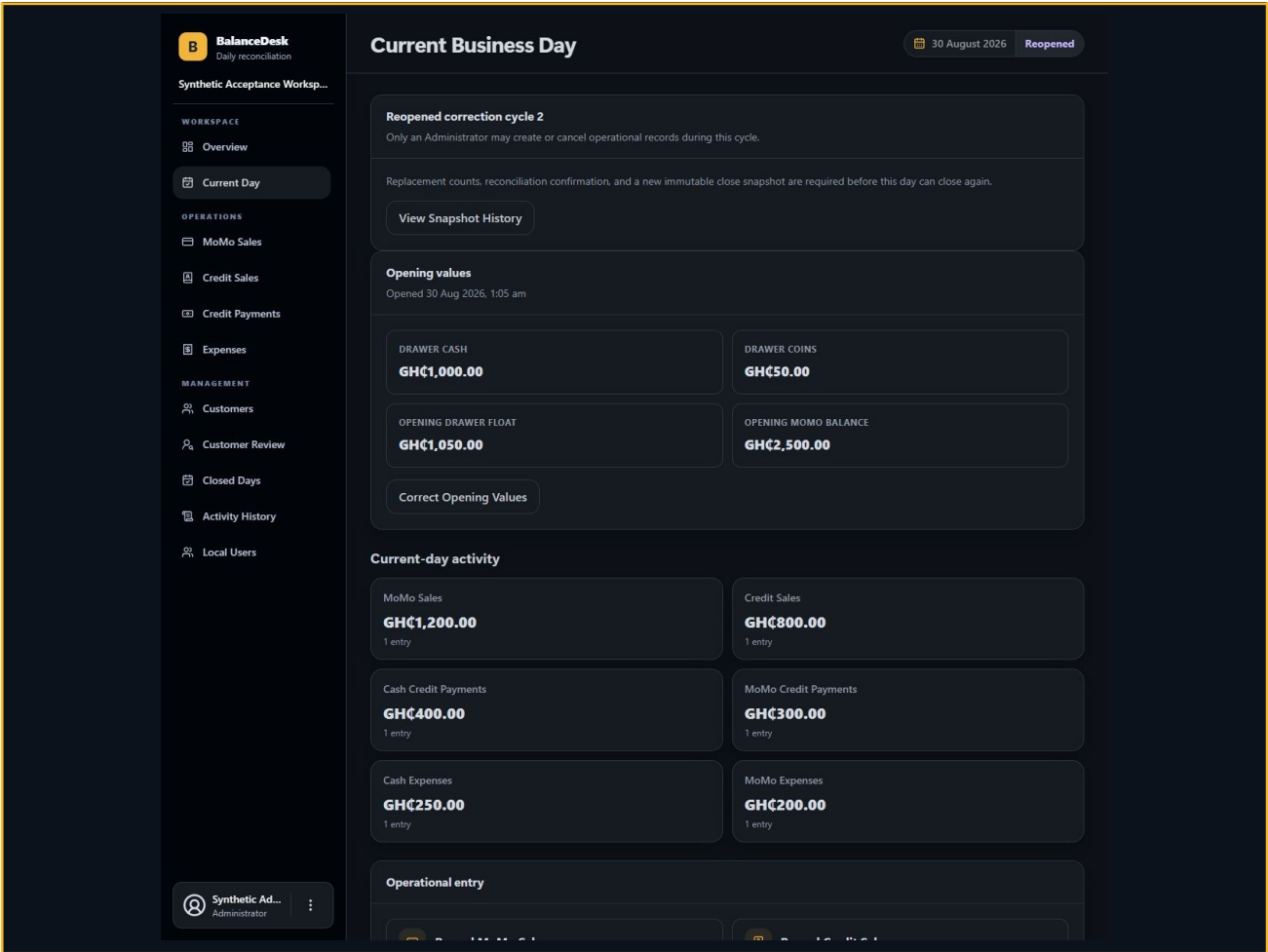
Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1 **Category** — Choose the category that best represents the cost.
- 2 **Description and amount** — Write a specific description and enter the amount paid.
- 3 **Payment channel** — Select Cash or MoMo exactly as payment was made.
- 4 **Date and evidence** — Confirm the date/time and record the payee and receipt reference when available.
- 5 **Submit** — Select Record Expense once, then confirm it in the list and day totals.

Note: The Reopened badge in this training image indicates a controlled correction cycle. Normal entry usually shows Open.

2.6 Use Current Day as the operating dashboard

Current Day shows opening values and live category totals. It is the fastest place to spot a missing or unexpected transaction before counts are submitted.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

1	Status — Confirm that the date and lifecycle status match the work you intend to perform.
2	Opening values — Review the starting drawer and MoMo balance before reconciling.
3	Activity totals — Compare MoMo Sales, Credit Sales, Credit Payments, and Expenses with source records.
4	Operational entry — Use the shortcuts to enter work or continue to counts when the day is complete.

Note: This image shows a reopened correction cycle. During a normal Open day, both Standard users and the Administrator can record authorised operations; reopening restricts correction entry to the Administrator.

SECTION 3

Customers and credit control

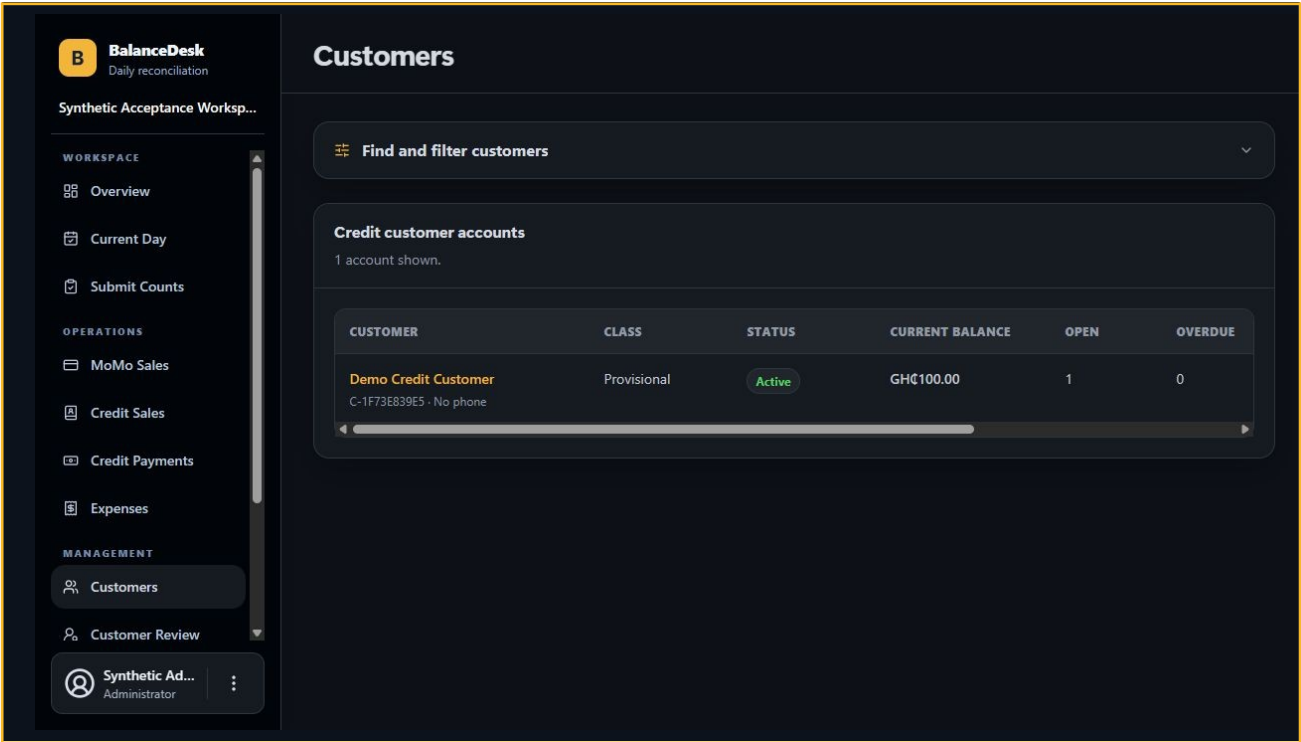
Customer records combine identity, invoices, payments, open balances, unallocated credit, and classification history.

Avoid duplicate customers

Search by name, customer code, and phone before creating a provisional customer. Duplicate accounts split balances and make follow-up harder.

3.1 Find a customer

The Customers table is designed to scroll horizontally on narrow screens so columns remain readable rather than being squeezed.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

1	Filters — Expand Find and filter customers to search by identity, classification, or status.
2	Account summary — Review class, status, current balance, open invoice count, overdue position, and unallocated credit.
3	Open account — Select the customer name to view the profile, credit position, invoice list, payments, and ledger.
4	Horizontal scroll — Use the table’s horizontal scrollbar when the window is narrow.

3.2 Read the customer credit position

Current balance is the net customer position. Open invoice total and unallocated credit are shown separately so you can understand why the figures differ.

BalanceDesk
Daily reconciliation

Synthetic Acceptance Worksp...

WORKSPACE

- Overview
- Open Business Day

OPERATIONS

- MoMo Sales
- Credit Sales
- Credit Payments
- Expenses

MANAGEMENT

- Customers
- Customer Review
- Closed Days

Demo Credit Customer

Customers Full ledger

Customer profile

Demo Credit Customer Active

C-1F73E839E5 · Provisional customer · No phone

Address: Demo Locality

Customer note: None

Admin note: None

Created: 30 Aug 2026, 1:07 am

Current credit position

Calculated for 30 August 2026.

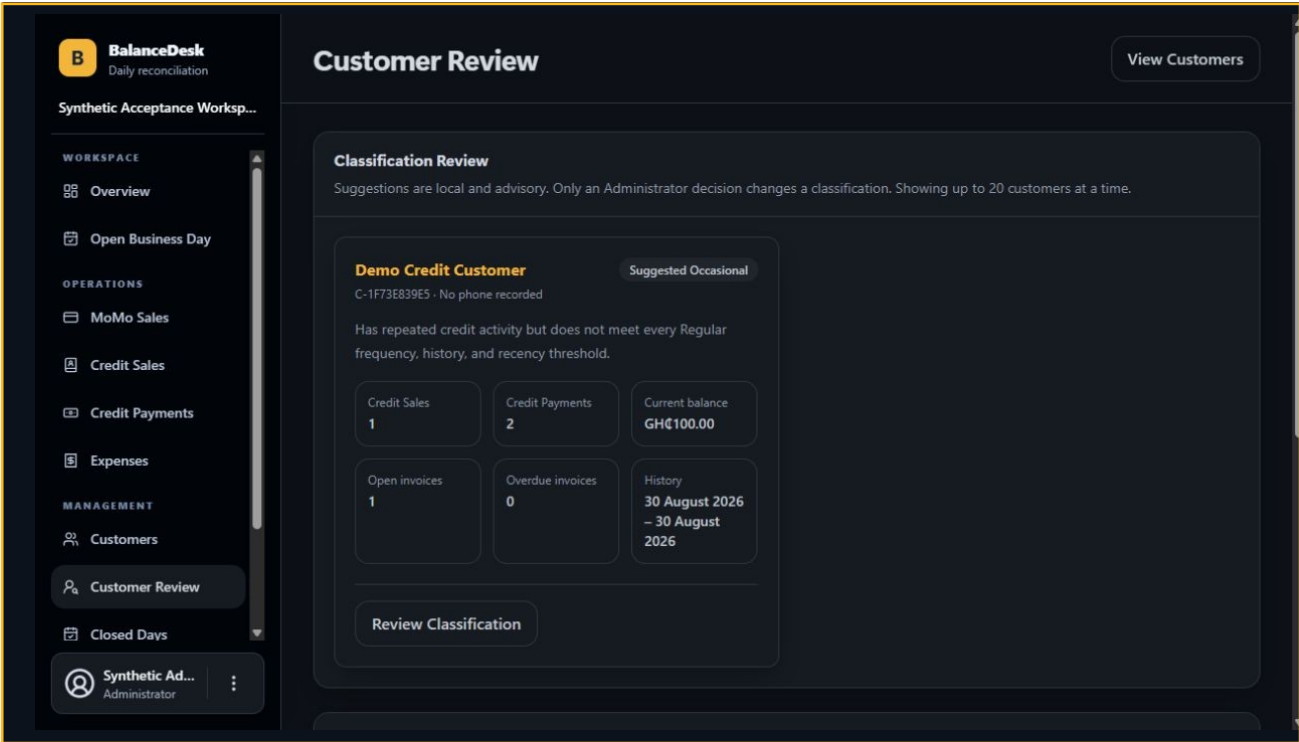
Current balance	Gross Credit Sales	Total Credit Payments	Open invoice total	Unallocated credit
GH¢100.00	GH¢800.00	GH¢700.00	GH¢400.00	GH¢300.00
Open Invoices	Overdue Invoices	Overdue amount	Last Credit Sale	Last Credit Payment
1	0	GH¢0.00	30 Aug 2026,	30 Aug 2026,

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- Profile** — Confirm you are viewing the right customer and check status, code, contact details, and notes.
- Current balance** — Gross Credit Sales minus total Credit Payments; this may be lower than open invoices when unallocated credit exists.
- Open invoices** — Review open and overdue counts and amounts before following up with the customer.
- Full ledger** — Use Full ledger for the dated history of credit sales, payments, allocations, reversals, and balances.

3.3 Review customer classifications — Administrator

Classification suggestions are advisory. Only an Administrator decision changes a customer from Provisional, Occasional, or Regular.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- Suggestion** — Read the suggested classification and the reason BalanceDesk presents it.
- Evidence** — Review sale count, payment count, balance, open invoices, overdue invoices, and history period.
- Decision** — Select Review Classification, inspect the account, and record the Administrator’s decision.

SECTION 4

Counts and reconciliation

Counts are physical facts. Reconciliation compares those facts with the recorded operations and the authoritative Total Sales figure.

Count independently

Do not derive the cash count from BalanceDesk. Physically count all cash and coins, and obtain the actual wallet balance from the MoMo source.

4.1 Submit end-of-day counts

Both fields deliberately start blank. Enter them from the real physical count and verified MoMo balance.

BalanceDesk
Daily reconciliation

Synthetic Acceptance Worksp...

WORKSPACE

- Overview
- Current Day
- Submit Counts

OPERATIONS

- MoMo Sales
- Credit Sales
- Credit Payments
- Expenses

MANAGEMENT

- Customers
- Customer Review

Synthetic Ad...
Administrator

Closing Counts

30 August 2026 Open

Submit end-of-day counts

Enter the physical cash and actual MoMo balances. Both fields start blank.

Total Cash Counted (GHS)

Actual Closing MoMo Balance (GHS)

Submit Closing Counts

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- Total Cash Counted** — Enter all physical cash and coins currently held for the day.
- Actual Closing MoMo** — Enter the wallet balance observed at closing.
- Submit** — Select Submit Closing Counts once. The day moves to Counts submitted.
- Correction** — If a value is wrong, use the authorised correction/return flow rather than inventing an offsetting transaction.

Administrator reconciliation sequence

- Enter the authoritative Total Sales figure from the approved source for that business date.
- Review Accounted Sales, Sales Difference, Sales Breakdown, Expected and Actual Closing MoMo, and MoMo Variance.
- Expand Opening values, Transaction totals, and Closing counts when you need to trace a figure.
- If records or counts are wrong, return to operations or counts, correct the source, and run the close sequence again.
- When the figures are understood, confirm the reconciliation. A non-zero difference must be acknowledged; add a meaningful audit explanation when required by your process.

4.2 Review the reconciliation — Administrator

Sales position and MoMo position are separate checks. The example is sales-balanced while showing a GH¢10.00 MoMo shortage.

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1 **Sales totals** — Compare Authoritative Total Sales with Accounted Sales. Difference is Accounted Sales minus Total Sales.
- 2 **Sales Breakdown** — Trace Calculated Cash Sales, MoMo Sales, and Credit Sales into Accounted Sales.
- 3 **MoMo Reconciliation** — Compare expected wallet closing balance with the actual balance and investigate any variance.
- 4 **Sales Position** — Balanced means the sales Difference is zero. Overage and shortage show the absolute direction when it is not.
- 5 **Next action** — Confirm only when figures are understood. Otherwise Return to Operations and correct the underlying source.

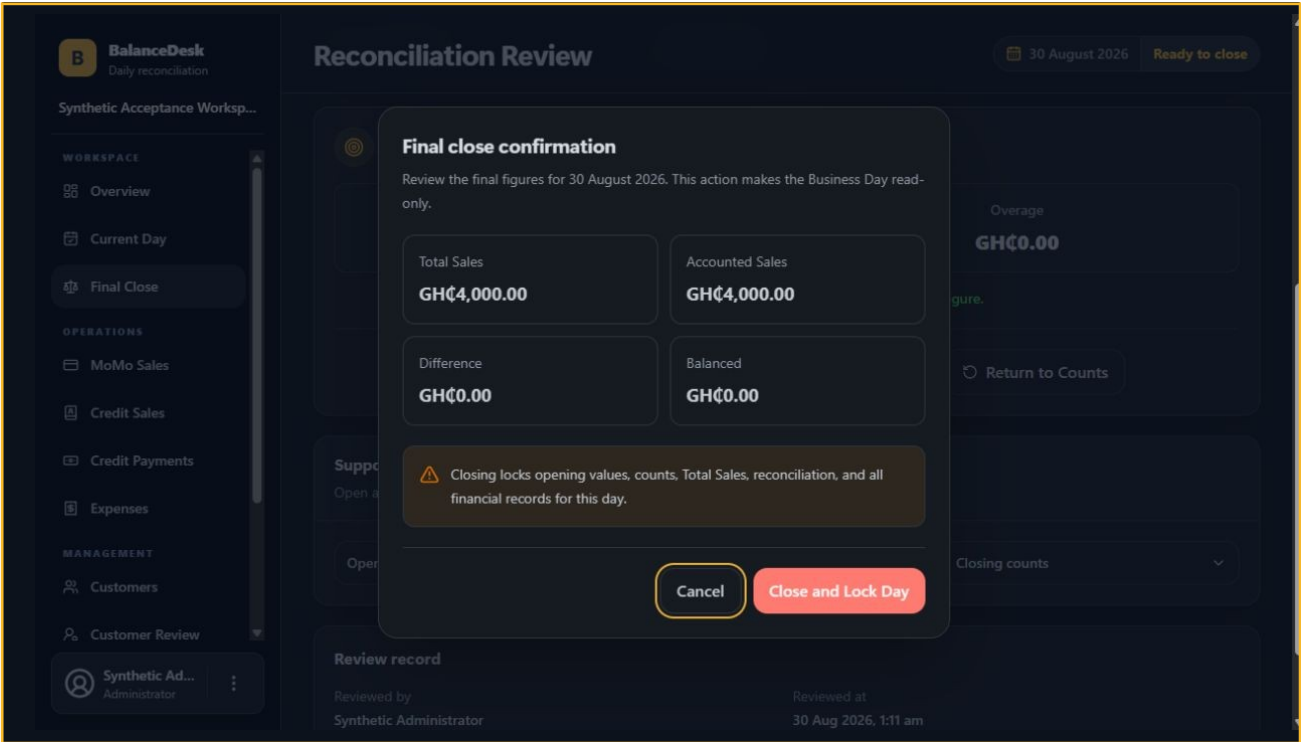
SECTION 5

Close, audit, and correct

Final close creates an immutable snapshot. Later corrections require an explicit controlled flow, not silent editing.

5.1 Final close confirmation — Administrator

Review the date and final figures one last time. Close and Lock Day makes opening values, counts, Total Sales, reconciliation, and financial records read-only.

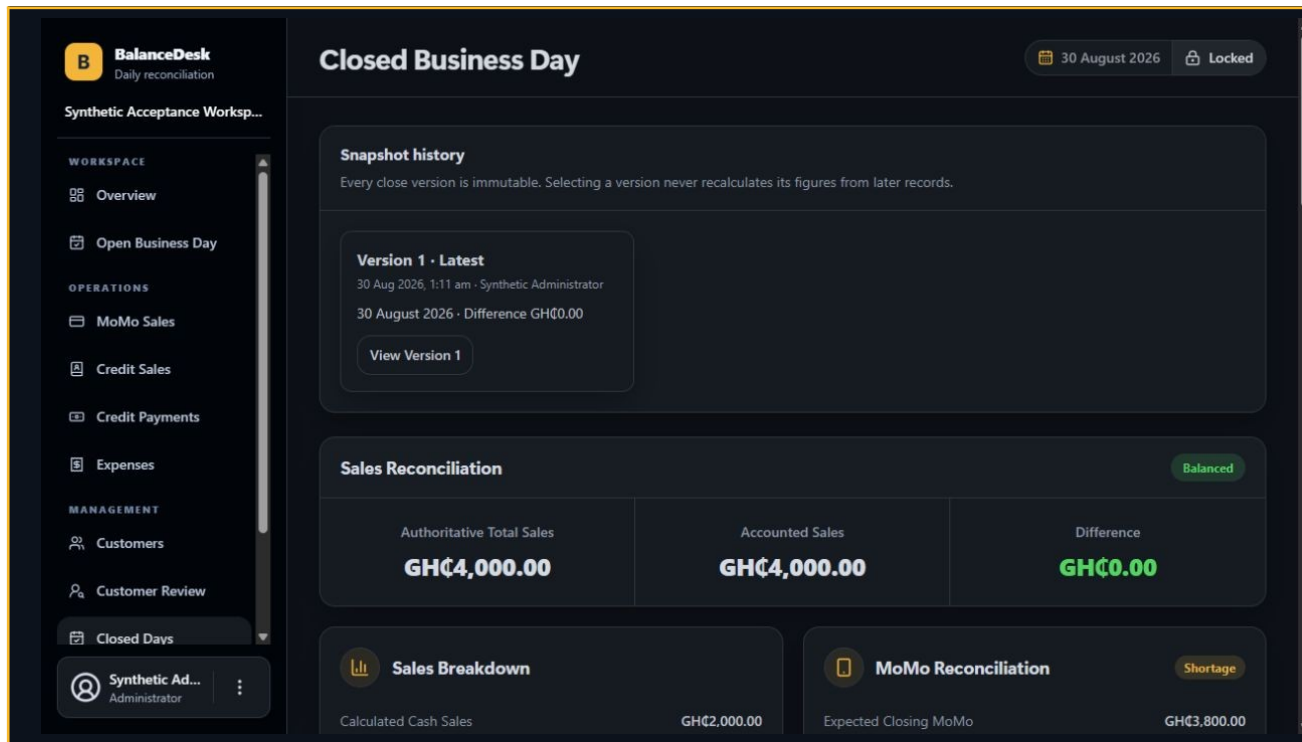


Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

1	Final figures — Check Total Sales, Accounted Sales, Difference, and balanced/variance position.
2	Lock warning — Understand that normal edits end when this action succeeds.
3	Cancel — Use Cancel if anything is uncertain and return to the correct source screen.
4	Close and Lock — Select only after the reconciliation has been approved for the business date.

5.2 Review a locked Business Day

Closed Days stores immutable snapshot versions. The screen does not recalculate an old snapshot from later customer or transaction changes.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

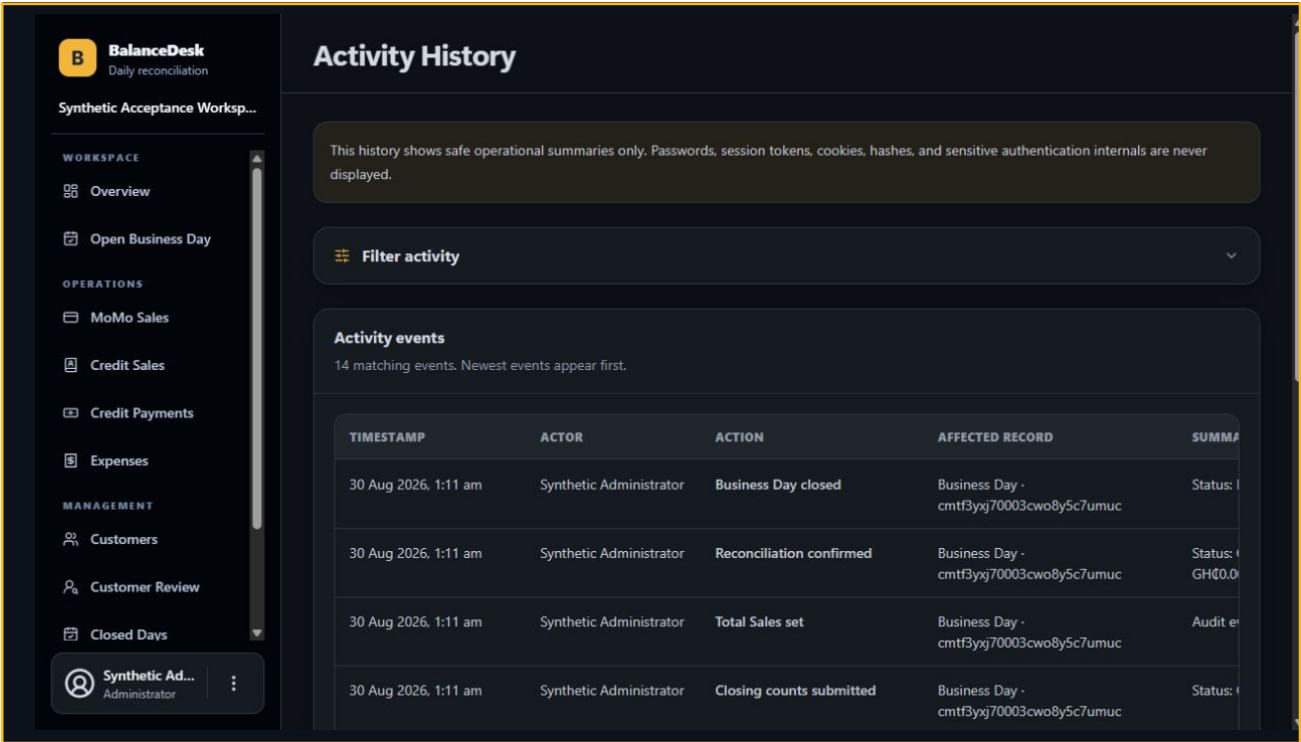
- 1 **Snapshot history** — Open a version to see exactly what was frozen at that close.
- 2 **Locked status** — The badge confirms that operational records are read-only.
- 3 **Reconciliation** — Review the final sales, breakdown, MoMo position, review record, and close record.
- 4 **Reopen** — Only an Administrator may reopen, and only when no other Business Day is active. A reason is recorded.

Safe correction choices

Situation	Use this action	Why
Wrong record while day is Open	Cancel/reverse through the authorised control	Financial records are retained; they are not physically deleted.
Counts submitted, but operations are wrong	Return to Operations	Correct source records, then submit fresh counts and review again.
Operations are right, but counts are wrong	Return to Counts / correct counts	Keeps the correction explicit and auditable.
Closed day needs correction	Reopen Business Day with a reason	Preserves the prior snapshot and starts a new controlled cycle.

5.3 Use Activity History — Administrator

Activity History records safe operational summaries for important actions. It deliberately excludes passwords, sessions, cookies, hashes, and authentication secrets.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

1	Filter — Filter by action, actor, affected record, or date when investigating an event.
2	Newest first — Recent closes, reconciliation confirmations, count submissions, and corrections appear first.
3	Affected record — Use the record type and ID to connect the event with the relevant day or transaction.
4	Summary — Read the safe summary; request diagnostics separately for technical health evidence.

SECTION 6

Local users and passwords

The first setup creates the local Administrator. That Administrator can create Standard users for daily entry.

6.1 Create a Standard user — Administrator

Use a unique username and give the temporary password to the intended user through a secure channel.

Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1 | Name — Enter the person's display name. |
| 2 | Username — Choose a unique, memorable local username. |
| 3 | Temporary password — Meet every displayed password rule and confirm the same value. |
| 4 | Create — Create the Standard user, then verify the account appears in the users list. |
| 5 | Maintain — Search the user list to reset or manage an authorised Standard account when necessary. |

Password responsibilities

- Use at least 8 characters and no more than 72 bytes.
- Include uppercase, lowercase, number, and symbol characters.
- Avoid common, sequential, repetitive, or identity-based patterns.
- Do not share accounts. Each person should use their own username so Activity History identifies the actor.
- Keep at least one working Administrator credential available before importing or moving a workspace.

SECTION 7

Data safety, backup, restore, and import

Your database is the workspace: it contains business identity, users, passwords, customers, transactions, reconciliation history, and audit records.

Stop BalanceDesk first

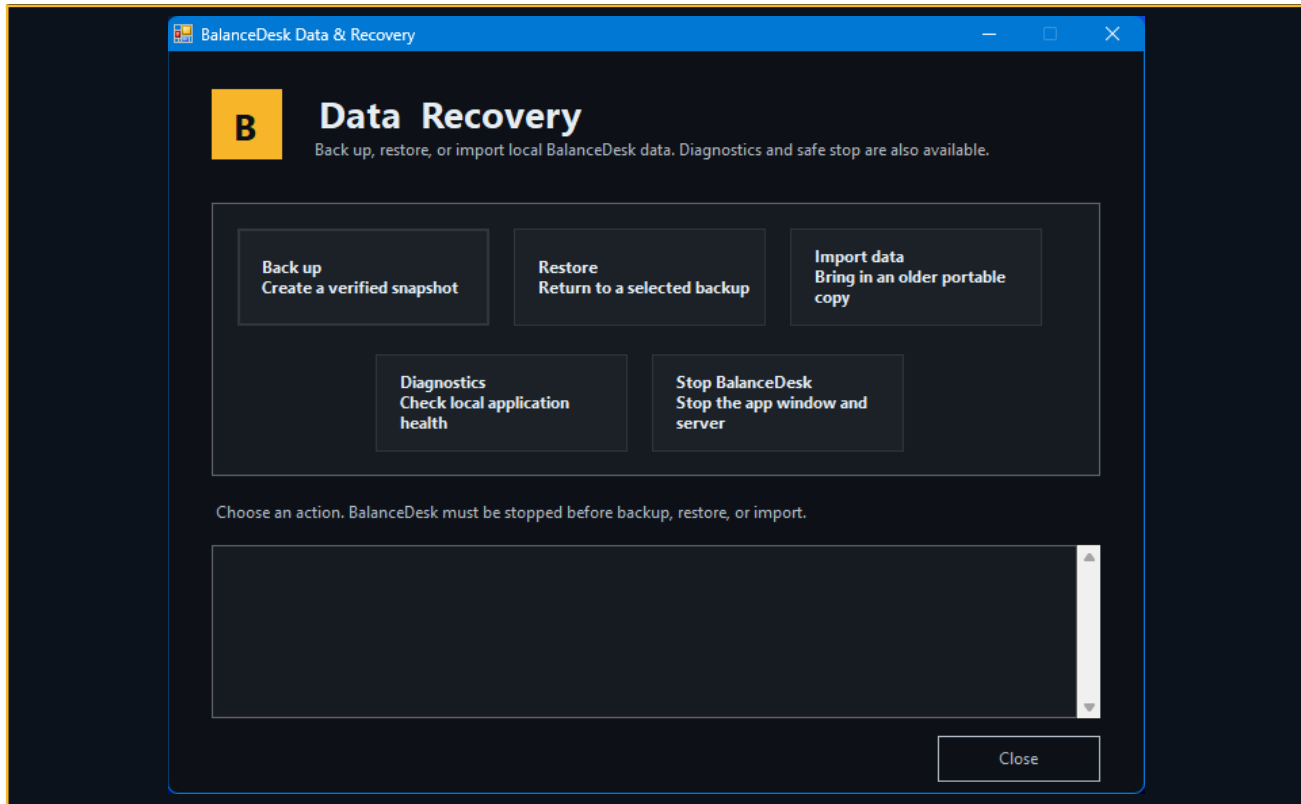
- ! Backup, restore, import, moving a portable folder, and applying an update must be performed while the BalanceDesk server is stopped.

Keep the live database local

- ! Do not place the active installed data folder or portable BalanceDesk folder on a network share, OneDrive, Dropbox, or another synchronised folder. Copy verified backups to separate protected storage instead.

7.1 Use Data & Recovery

Open BalanceDesk Data & Recovery from Windows Start. The central window groups maintenance actions while standalone Stop and Diagnostics entries remain available.



Screen markup — follow the numbered notes below from top to bottom.

- 1 **Back up** — After stopping BalanceDesk, create a verified timestamped snapshot of the active workspace.
- 2 **Restore** — Choose a trusted BalanceDesk .db backup and enter RESTORE. A pre-restore safety copy is created.
- 3 **Import data** — Choose a trusted .db file or extracted portable folder and enter IMPORT. The entire active workspace is replaced.
- 4 **Diagnostics** — Check runtime, settings, database integrity, migrations, and the local port.
- 5 **Stop** — Safely close the app window and private local server before maintenance.

Note: Wait for the green success message and read the displayed result path before closing the tool.

Recommended backup routine

1. Close the BalanceDesk app window normally, or use Stop BalanceDesk from Windows Start.
2. Open BalanceDesk Data & Recovery and select Back up.
3. Wait for the verified-success result and note the backup path.
4. Keep the local backup and copy another verified backup to protected external storage under your normal business policy.
5. Create an additional backup before every update, restore, import, or computer migration.

Restore versus import

Action	Select	Confirmation	Effect
Restore	A trusted BalanceDesk backup .db	RESTORE	Returns this installation to that backup; creates a pre-restore safety copy.
Import	A trusted .db or extracted portable BalanceDesk folder	IMPORT	Replaces the active workspace and activates the imported users and passwords.

No merge



Restore and import do not combine two workspaces. The selected database becomes active. Verify the selected business and know an Administrator login before continuing.

Run Diagnostics

- Open Diagnostics from Windows Start or from Data & Recovery.
- Read the health summary and the checks for the bundled runtime, production server, database tool, template, local settings, SQLite integrity, migration baseline, and local port.
- Open the timestamped diagnostic report when support requests technical evidence. The report excludes passwords, setup codes, session secrets, and business records.
- After a corrective action, run Diagnostics again and confirm that every required check passes.

Protect technical reports



A diagnostic report is designed for support, but it can still contain local file paths and device details. Share it only through an authorised support channel.

Update or reinstall safely

- Stop BalanceDesk and create a verified backup before applying an update.
- Run the newer installer for the same Windows account. Detected installed data is preserved.
- Open BalanceDesk, sign in, verify the business name and recent records, then run Diagnostics.
- Uninstall removes application files but deliberately keeps %LOCALAPPDATA%\BalanceDesk data and backups. Reinstalling reconnects to retained data.

SECTION 8

Troubleshooting

Preserve the database, backups, logs, and diagnostic reports. Most support problems can be investigated without deleting business data.

Symptom	Safe response
BalanceDesk says another operation is in progress	Wait briefly. Use Stop BalanceDesk, then open it once. If repeated, run Diagnostics and preserve the report.
App window does not open	Open BalanceDesk from Start once. If it still fails, use Stop, run Diagnostics, and keep the data folder unchanged.
Screen appears stale after a submit	Do not submit again immediately. Refresh once or reopen BalanceDesk, then check the record list/current totals to see whether the entry already saved.
Button stays on Processing/Recording	Wait, avoid repeated clicks, refresh or reopen, and verify the record before retrying. Preserve logs and a diagnostic report if it recurs.
Backup/restore/import refuses to run	BalanceDesk is probably active. Close the app window or use Stop, then repeat the maintenance action.
Imported workspace opens at login	This is expected. Sign in with an account from the imported workspace; newly created pre-import credentials no longer apply.
Forgot a Standard-user password	Ask the local Administrator to manage/reset that user. Do not replace or delete the database.
No Administrator login after import	Use the original credentials from the imported workspace. If unavailable, restore the pre-import rollback copy and seek support.
Windows shows unknown publisher	Use only the official release and verify the supplied SHA-256 checksum before running it.

When requesting support



Provide the BalanceDesk version, Windows or Linux version, the exact message, what action preceded it, whether the record appears after reopening, and the diagnostic report. Do not send passwords, setup codes, or live business data unless a secure, authorised process specifically requires it.

SECTION 9

Linux x64 quick reference

The Linux .tar.gz archive is a portable distribution. It is not a system-wide installer and keeps settings, data, backups, diagnostics, logs, and runtime state inside the extracted BalanceDesk folder.

Supported	Not supported
64-bit x86 Linux (x86-64)	ARM systems
glibc 2.28 or newer	Alpine or other musl systems
OpenSSL 3 providing libssl.so.3	Systems with only older OpenSSL libraries

First use

1. Extract the complete .tar.gz archive to a normal writable local folder. Do not run it from inside the archive.
2. Run Setup BalanceDesk.sh once from the extracted folder.
3. Keep the printed first-run Administrator setup code private and enter it only on the local setup screen.
4. Open BalanceDesk from the application menu, desktop shortcut, or the BalanceDesk launcher in the extracted folder.

Everyday and maintenance use

- Use Stop BalanceDesk.sh or the Stop action in Data & Recovery when you finish. Closing a normal browser tab may not stop the private local server.
- Always stop before backup, restore, import, moving, or updating the extracted folder.
- Use BalanceDesk Data & Recovery for the same verified backup, restore, import, diagnostics, and stop workflows described in Section 7.
- Private directories use mode 0700 and private files use mode 0600; opening the hardened package repairs these permissions in an existing extracted workspace.

Update or move the Linux copy

1. Stop BalanceDesk and retain a verified backup.
2. Extract the new package to a separate local folder and run Setup in that folder.
3. Use Import existing data and select the old extracted folder or its data/balancedesk.db file.
4. Confirm the business and records before removing the old folder; keep at least one independent backup.

Keep the package together



Do not copy only the executable or only the app folder. The extracted package includes its private runtime, operational tools, settings, and data structure.

APPENDIX A

How BalanceDesk calculates the day

All values below are in Ghana cedis for readability. BalanceDesk performs precise money calculations internally.

Figure	Calculation
Opening Drawer Float	Drawer Cash + Drawer Coins
Calculated Cash Sales	Total Cash Counted – Drawer Cash – Drawer Coins – Cash Credit Payments + Cash Expenses
Expected Closing MoMo	Opening MoMo + MoMo Sales + MoMo Credit Payments – MoMo Expenses
Accounted Sales	Calculated Cash Sales + MoMo Sales + Credit Sales
Sales Difference	Accounted Sales – Authoritative Total Sales
MoMo Variance	Actual Closing MoMo – Expected Closing MoMo

Worked example used in this guide

Input	Amount
Drawer Cash / Drawer Coins / Opening MoMo	GH¢1,000.00 / GH¢50.00 / GH¢2,500.00
MoMo Sales / Credit Sales	GH¢1,200.00 / GH¢800.00
Cash / MoMo Credit Payments	GH¢400.00 / GH¢300.00
Cash / MoMo Expenses	GH¢250.00 / GH¢200.00
Total Cash Counted / Actual Closing MoMo	GH¢3,200.00 / GH¢3,790.00
Authoritative Total Sales	GH¢4,000.00

Calculated Cash Sales: $3,200 - 1,000 - 50 - 400 + 250 = \text{GH¢}2,000.00$

Accounted Sales: $2,000 + 1,200 + 800 = \text{GH¢}4,000.00$

Sales Difference: $4,000 - 4,000 = \text{GH¢}0.00$ (balanced)

Expected Closing MoMo: $2,500 + 1,200 + 300 - 200 = \text{GH¢}3,800.00$

MoMo Variance: $3,790 - 3,800 = -\text{GH¢}10.00$ (shortage)



Two independent results

A day can be sales-balanced and still have a MoMo variance. Investigate both before final close.

APPENDIX B

End-of-day checklist

Print or reuse this sequence during training until the close workflow becomes familiar.

☐	1. All MoMo Sales entered and checked against provider evidence.
☐	2. All Credit Sales linked to the right customers and invoice references.
☐	3. All Credit Payments recorded with the correct channel and allocation.
☐	4. All Expenses recorded with category, description, channel, and evidence reference.
☐	5. Current Day totals reviewed for missing or duplicate entries.
☐	6. Physical cash and coins counted independently.
☐	7. Actual closing MoMo balance obtained from the source.
☐	8. Closing Counts submitted once and verified.
☐	9. Authoritative Total Sales entered from the approved source.
☐	10. Sales Difference and MoMo Variance understood and documented where needed.
☐	11. Reconciliation confirmed by an Administrator.
☐	12. Final figures checked and Business Day closed and locked.
☐	13. Locked snapshot reviewed in Closed Days when required.
☐	14. BalanceDesk stopped and a verified backup created according to policy.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Authoritative Total Sales	The approved external Total Sales figure entered by an Administrator for comparison.
Accounted Sales	Calculated Cash Sales plus MoMo Sales plus Credit Sales recorded for the day.
Sales Difference	Accounted Sales minus Authoritative Total Sales.
MoMo Variance	Actual closing MoMo minus expected closing MoMo.
Unallocated credit	A customer payment amount not yet assigned to a specific open invoice.
Snapshot	An immutable record of the reconciled figures and close state at a particular close version.
Reopen	An Administrator-controlled correction cycle that preserves the prior snapshot.

REFERENCE

Support and release information

Product: BalanceDesk

Guide version: 1.2.0

Primary platform: Windows x64 installer and portable package

Additional platform: Linux x64 portable distribution with glibc 2.28+ and OpenSSL 3

Local service: 127.0.0.1:3210 only; not exposed to other devices

Official public repository: <https://github.com/Ritchalison/BalanceDesk>

Before contacting support

- i** Create a verified backup, preserve logs and diagnostics, and record the exact on-screen message. Never send a password or setup code.

BalanceDesk is proprietary software and is not open source.

See LICENSE.md for permitted use and restrictions.